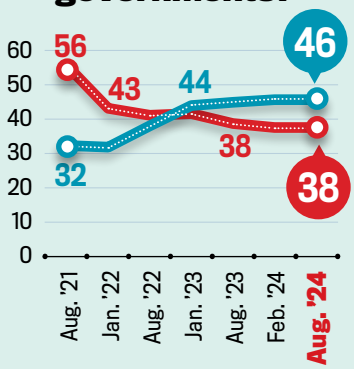
Q. Do you think the BJP govt misuses enforcement agencies such as the ED, CBI and IT department more than other governments?



Q. How do you view the arrest of two CMs, Arvind Kejriwal and Hemant Soren, by the ED and the CBI?

Both arrests were not justified and the agencies were not doing their job. It was just a political vendetta against the two	36
Both arrests were justified and the agencies were just doing their job	30
Hemant Soren's arrest was right but not Arvind Kejriwal's	5
Arvind Kejriwal's arrest was right but not Hemant Soren's	5

All figures in % and rounded off; rest, DK/CS

45%

of the upper caste Hindu respondents say that the arrests of Kejriwal and Soren were justified and the agencies were doing their job

their current expenses have become difficult to manage and that their economic status has either remained the same or deteriorated since Modi took charge as PM in 2014. The perception that the NDA government's economic policies largely benefit big business persists and is now 58.3 per cent. The only silver lining for the Modi government is the growing optimism among the voters who believe the economic situation will improve in the next six months. They also continue to express faith in the NDA government's handling of the economy, with 52 per cent rating it as good and outstanding, though there is a 12.3 percentage point drop in the number of respondents who rate the government's handling of the economy as outstanding—from 32.4 per cent to 20.1 per cent.

There are negative perceptions on other fronts in the current MOTN that could compound the BJP's woes. For instance, nearly half the respondents hold the central government and its examination bodies responsible for the malpractices in the national entrance examinations to India's higher education institutions. On the controversial Agnipath scheme of recruitment for the armed forces, 38.3 per cent want it improved upon and more than a fourth want it to be discontinued altogether. Similar reservations are evident over the passing of the three new national criminal laws. The government is attracting flak for misusing central investigative agencies for political gain, with 36 per cent of the respondents saying that the arrests of Opposition chief ministers Arvind Kejriwal in Delhi and Hemant Soren in Jharkhand by the Enforcement Directorate and the Central Bureau of Investigation were unjustified and political vendetta on the part of the ruling party. In a separate question, as many as 46.3 percent say the BJP has misused these investigating agencies more than the previous governments.

There is also overwhelming support for two contentious issues on which the Modi government is not inclined to yield—legally guaranteeing MSP or the minimum support price (MSP) for agricultural produce and initiating a caste census across the country. Given the spate of rail accidents recently, over 43 per cent believe that the Indian Railways has not done enough to make train journeys safe. Women's safety continues to be a cause for concern, with 37.9 per cent saying India has become less safe for them, and this before the Kolkata rape and murder came to light. When it comes to communal harmony, a high 28.1 per cent still believe it has deteriorated and a majority holds the BJP-RSS responsible. However, when it comes to two of the NDA's government pet initiatives—implementing a universal civil code and the idea of one nation, one poll—the respondents give a clear thumbs-up.

NDA's three biggest achievements in the past—the Ram temple, revoking Art. 370 and welfare schemes—have begun yielding diminishing electoral returns